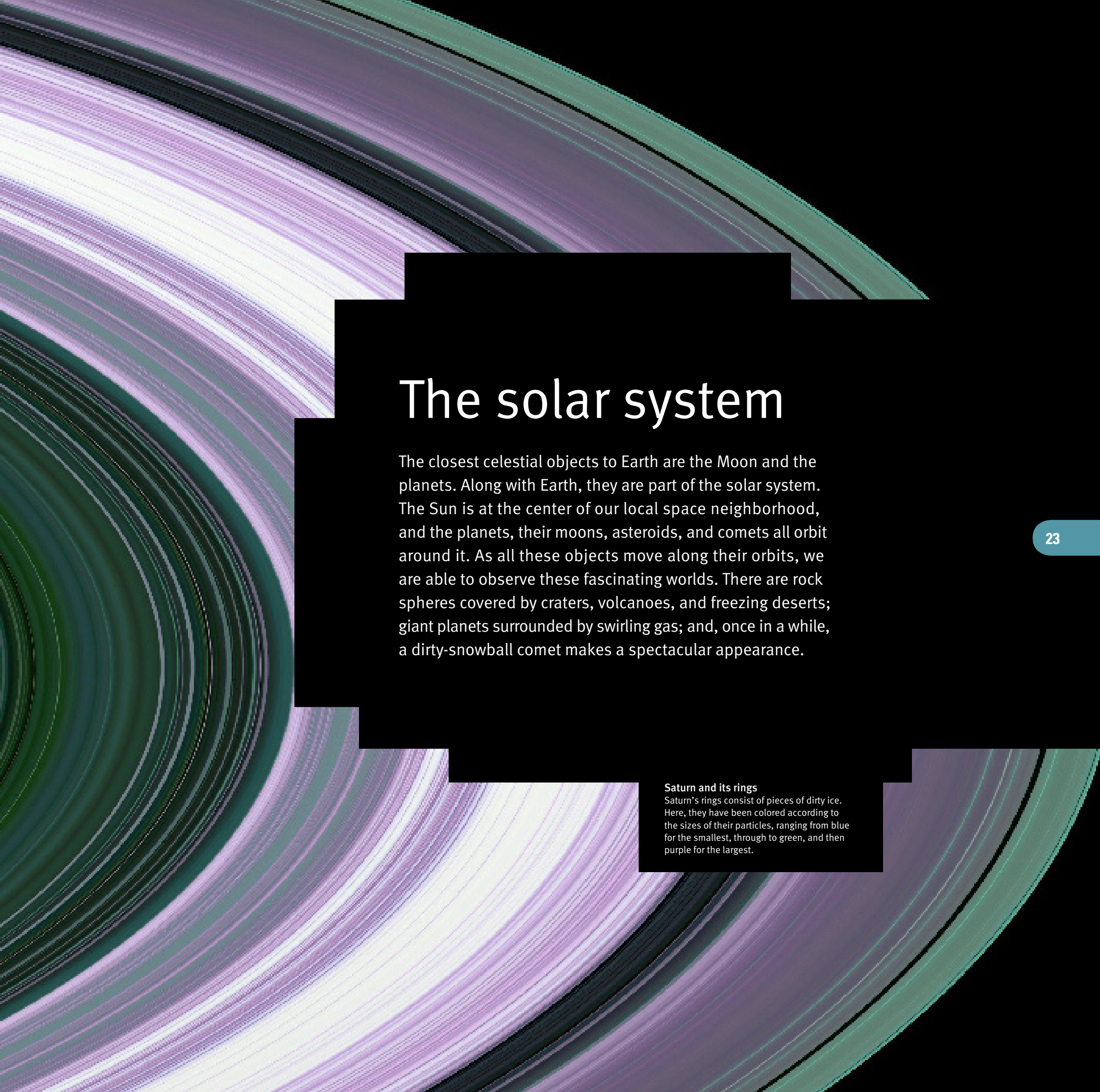




The solar system

The closest celestial objects to Earth are the Moon and the planets. Along with Earth, they are part of the solar system. The Sun is at the center of our local space neighborhood, and the planets, their moons, asteroids, and comets all orbit around it. As all these objects move along their orbits, we are able to observe these fascinating worlds. There are rock spheres covered by craters, volcanoes, and freezing deserts; giant planets surrounded by swirling gas; and, once in a while, a dirty-snowball comet makes a spectacular appearance.

Saturn and its rings

Saturn's rings consist of pieces of dirty ice. Here, they have been colored according to the sizes of their particles, ranging from blue for the smallest, through to green, and then purple for the largest.